

Table 68.7 How Often Stops Hit

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Pattern top	2%	1%
Middle	17%	10%
Pattern bottom	72%	69%

Table 68.8 Performance and Failures Over Time for Bull Markets

Description	Bull Market
1990s	−17%
2000s	−13%
2010s	−14%
Performance (above), Failures (below)	
1990s	16%
2000s	30%
2010s	27%

Table 68.8 shows the performance over three decades. I don't include bear markets because they happened only in the 2000s.

Performance over time. The 1990s showed the best performance, but returns have leveled off in the most recent two decades.

Failures over time. Failures were worst in the 2000s and best in the 1990s. The 1990s had the fewest samples, though (71). The other two decades had two or three times as many samples. I'm just throwing that out to see if it sticks. It might explain the differences.

Table 68.9 shows busted pattern performance.

Busted patterns count. Triple tops bust a lot in bull markets (almost half will bust). Notice that only 14% bust in bear markets.

Busted occurrence. I sorted busted patterns by how often they busted. Single busts occur most often, as one might expect, but triple+ (more than two busts) place second. We've seen this happen in other chart patterns, too. **Figure 68.5** shows a triple+ busted pattern. Price turns like a corkscrew.